



WORKING TITLE (To be confirmed)

Occasion Wear Rental Business

A premium, accessible and reusable approach to dressing for life's special moments in Nigeria.

Business Proposal.





1. The Vision

Build a trusted occasion-wear rental brand that makes beautiful clothing easier to access, reuse and enjoy.

- Start with carefully selected women's occasion wear and a strong customer experience.
 - Build around reuse: customers can enjoy high-quality pieces without needing to purchase every outfit.
 - Grow into a broader occasion-wear platform serving women, men and children.
 - Keep the business bigger than the founder: the final brand name will be independent of a personal identity.
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2. The Opportunity

Many special occasions create a familiar problem: people want to look exceptional, but buying a new outfit for every event can be expensive and impractical.

- Weddings, birthdays, graduations, parties, photoshoots and celebrations create repeated demand for occasion wear.
- Children often outgrow outfits before they have had much use, creating an especially strong case for rental and reuse.
- Men's occasion wear such as tuxedos and agbadas can become future categories.
- The opportunity is not simply 'renting dresses' — it is providing convenient access to occasion-ready looks.

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3. The Core Customer Promise

Look memorable. Spend intentionally. Return it. Let someone else enjoy it next.

- Quality and visual appeal without the full cost of ownership.
- Simple browsing, booking, collection/delivery and return process.
- Clear sizing, garment information and realistic photos.
- A reliable and professional rental experience that builds trust.
- A model that encourages garments to be worn more than once rather than sitting unused.

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4. Products & Services — Phase One

Keep the initial offer focused so the business can prove demand before expanding.

- Women's occasion dresses for weddings, birthdays, parties, graduations and other events.
- A curated collection rather than an overwhelming catalogue.
- Rental periods and pricing designed around the type of occasion and garment.
- Refundable damage/security deposits where appropriate.
- Optional accessories can be introduced once the core rental process is stable.

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5. Future Product Expansion

The brand should have room to grow beyond dresses.

- Men's occasion wear: tuxedos, suits and traditional pieces such as agbada.
- Children's occasion wear, especially outfits suitable for birthdays, weddings and photoshoots.
- Accessories and styling add-ons.
- Eventually, selected maternity occasion wear if demand supports it.
- Creative rental products such as photography backdrops and props as a later-stage extension.

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6. Why Backdrops & Props Belong Later

The idea is valuable — but it should strengthen the business rather than distract from the launch.

- The first stage should establish the rental systems, customer trust, garment care and cash flow.
- Locally made artistic backdrops could become a distinctive future product line.
- Abeokuta and other creative communities could be explored for locally produced tie-dye, painted or textile-based backdrops.
- Photography props could eventually create a second rental category for photographers, maternity shoots and family sessions.
- The business name therefore needs to be broad enough for future creative rentals.

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7. Customer Journey

A simple process is essential for trust and repeat bookings.

- 1 — Browse: customer views available pieces, sizes, measurements and photos.
- 2 — Select: customer chooses the garment and rental date.
- 3 — Verify & pay: identity details, rental fee and applicable deposit are confirmed.
- 4 — Collect or receive: garment is provided in presentation-ready condition.
- 5 — Wear & enjoy: customer uses the item for the agreed period.
- 6 — Return: item is returned by the agreed deadline.
- 7 — Inspect & reset: garment is checked, cleaned and prepared for the next booking.

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8. Business & Revenue Model

Start simple, measure what works, then expand.

- Primary revenue: rental fees.
- Secondary revenue: accessories, delivery/collection fees and selected add-ons.
- Refundable deposits can protect inventory but should be clearly separated from rental revenue.
- Illustrative starting point discussed: around \$25,000 per rental; actual pricing should be set garment-by-garment after costs and market testing.
- Track revenue per garment, utilization, cleaning/repair costs, cancellations and repeat customers.

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9. Risk Management

The rental model succeeds when expectations are clear before the garment leaves the business.

- Identity verification: collect appropriate customer identification/contact details before releasing higher-value items.
- Rental agreement: document rental period, payment, deposit, return condition and customer responsibilities.
- Damage/loss policy: define ordinary wear versus chargeable damage or loss.
- Late-return fees: set a clear fee structure because one late item can affect another customer's booking.
- Condition checks: photograph or record garment condition before and after each rental.
- Cleaning and maintenance: build cleaning, steaming, repairs and replacement into operating costs.
- Inventory tracking: maintain a record of every garment, size, condition, booking and maintenance history.

10. Marketing Strategy

Make the brand visual, trustworthy and occasion-led.

- Instagram/TikTok: strong outfit photography, styling videos, customer transformations and behind-the-scenes content.
- Occasion-based marketing: 'What to wear to a wedding', graduation looks, birthday looks and seasonal collections.
- Partnerships: photographers, makeup artists, hairstylists, event planners and wedding vendors.
- Referral strategy: encourage satisfied customers to bring friends and return for future occasions.
- User-generated content: with permission, showcase customers wearing the pieces.
- Photography can become a strategic advantage: professional imagery makes a rental catalogue feel premium.

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11. Operations

The invisible systems will determine whether the brand feels premium.

- Curate inventory based on demand rather than buying large quantities immediately.
- Assign each garment a unique inventory record.
- Create a standard pre-rental and post-return inspection checklist.
- Use consistent packaging and garment presentation.
- Set clear turnaround times for cleaning and repairs.
- Introduce delivery/collection only when the economics and logistics make sense.

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12. Financial Framework

The first financial goal is not maximum scale — it is proving a repeatable, profitable rental cycle.

- Key startup costs: initial inventory, photography/content, packaging, storage, cleaning/steaming, alterations and marketing.
- Key ongoing costs: cleaning, repairs, replacement, delivery, platform/payment fees and customer acquisition.
- Important metric: contribution per rental after direct cleaning, maintenance and transaction costs.
- Illustrative rental price: \$25,000 is a planning example, not a final market price.
- Before launch, test several price points against garment cost, expected number of rentals and replacement value.

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13. Three-Year Growth Roadmap

Grow in stages rather than trying to launch every idea at once.

- **Year 1 — Build & Prove:** establish the women's occasion-wear collection, customer process, brand identity, risk controls and repeat customers.
- **Year 2 — Expand:** grow the strongest-performing categories, introduce selected accessories, improve digital booking and test children's or men's pieces.
- **Year 3 — Broaden:** develop a wider occasion-wear ecosystem and selectively introduce creative add-ons such as props/backdrops where demand is proven.

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14. Five-Year Vision

A flexible brand umbrella rather than a business trapped inside one product.

- Become a recognizable occasion-wear rental brand with strong customer trust.
- Operate a broader catalogue across women's, men's and children's occasion wear.
- Explore partnerships, delivery coverage and potentially a physical showroom or studio environment.
- Develop locally distinctive products, including creative textile/backdrop collaborations.
- Build systems that allow the company to operate successfully even when the founder is not physically present in Nigeria.

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15. Brand Direction & Naming

The name should describe a world, not just a dress.

- The photography identity remains separate and personal; this business should stand independently.
- Avoid a name that limits the company to women's dresses or one category.
- The eventual name should still make sense if the company rents tuxedos, agbadas, children's outfits, props or backdrops.
- Potential creative territory discussed: 'Borrow', 'House', 'Canvas', 'Occasion', 'Studio' and similar umbrella concepts.
- Final name: TO BE CONFIRMED

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16. Executive Summary

The business concept in one page.

- A premium occasion-wear rental business designed to make high-quality fashion more accessible while encouraging reuse.
- The launch focus is women's occasion wear, supported by a professional booking, verification, care and return process.
- The longer-term brand can expand into men's and children's occasion wear, accessories, and carefully selected creative rentals such as photography backdrops and props.
- The strategy is deliberately phased: prove the core rental model first, then expand into categories that demonstrate real customer demand.
- The brand will operate independently from the founder's personal photography identity, creating room for the business to grow beyond one individual.

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